rising surge of cases. He noted that about 70 districts in the country were witnessing a rise of over 150 per cent cases and urged them to take quick and decisive steps to stop the emerging second peak of COVID-19. He further insisted that states increase their RT-PCR testing and carefully follow the SOP for surveillance of contact of travellers coming from abroad. He further directed the states to continue to spread awareness of COVID-19-appropriate behaviour and strictly enforce it amongst people.[63] Parallely, Union Home Minister Amit Shah too held a review meeting and gave directives to various authorities to augment supply of oxygen for medical purposes. An expert group especially formed for the purpose was directed to optimize and rationalize the allocation to states and UTs. Additionally, the Ministry of Home Affairs wrote to all states and UTs to ensure that adequate security was provided to oxygen-transporting vehicles and accordingly make provisions for exclusive corridors for transportation. The MoHFW too continued to engage with states from time to time in order to guide their response to the wave of infections. With high caseload states, they engaged on a one-on-one format to provide any and all possible assistance to them.

Proficient at playing the victim card, Kejriwal broadcast a section of the video conference between the prime minister and the chief ministers of a dramatized appeal he had made with folded hands to the prime minister to direct all chief ministers to allow smooth movement of oxygen tankers coming to Delhi. Telecasting a live conversation with the prime minister was a clear breach of protocol and the prime minister had to pull him up during the conversation, 'Let me say something, this is strictly against our tradition, our protocol… that a chief minister is running a live telecast of an in-house meeting. This is inappropriate and we must refrain from doing so.'[64] [65] Oddly, Kejriwal raised points of airlifting oxygen and bringing in oxygen via the oxygen express trains with no knowledge that the former was already being done and for the latter, the Delhi government had placed no request with the Union government to do so yet. The wily move seemed to be a manoeuvre to steer away the conversation from what other chief ministers were doing in their respective states to one that would place the blame for Delhi's woes on the Centre.

Despite the Delhi government's mishandling of the oxygen distribution and management, allowing it to be traded in the black market unchecked, the Delhi High Court warned the Centre that if it doesn't provide 590 MT of